

[illegible]

U.S. CENSUS BUREAU

American Community Survey

- The American Community Survey (ACS) is a widely used survey to understand many features of the population, including labor-market outcomes and something we will study today – health insurance coverage
- IPUMS USA (same organization that produces IPUMS CPS), provides harmonized versions of the ACS
 - IPUMS USA contains decennial census microdata from 1790 to 2010 and ACS from 2000

ACS 2023

- On Canvas I have added three files
 - acs_clean_healthcare.csv
 - acs_clean_healthcare.xlsx
 - acs_clean_healthcare.dta
- These files are restricted to individuals aged 55-75. For the excel file I further restricted to the first 100,000 individuals, as the size of the data could be an issue in Excel

Variables

- File contains a number of binary indicator variables
 - These are variables that take on either a value of zero or one.
 - These include `has_health_insurance`, `has_medicare`, `in_labor_force`

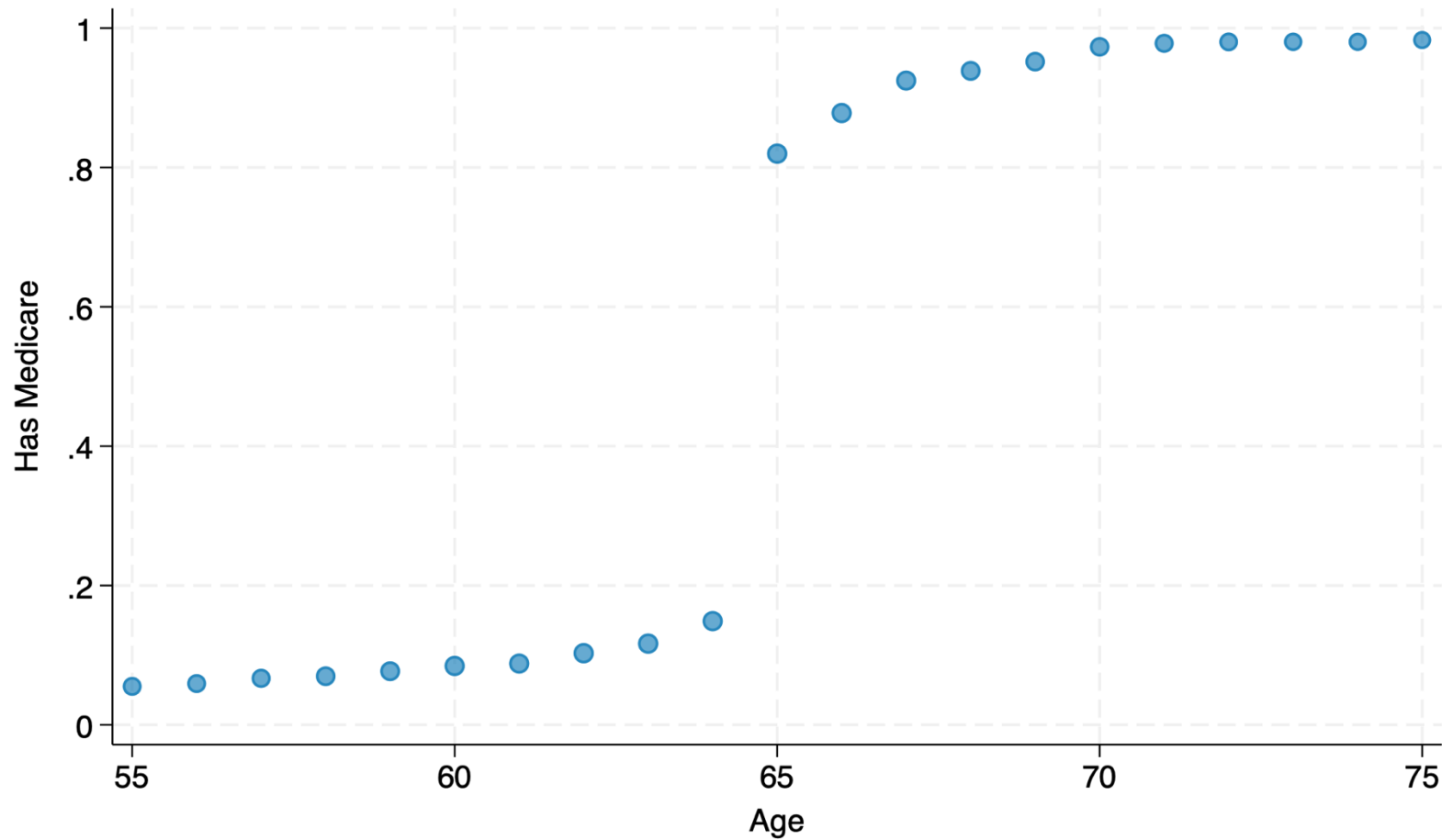
Retirement

- There are a number of age-based policies that may impact retirement decisions
 - Early retirement (62): You are eligible to receive Social Security at age 62. Monthly benefits are permanently lower if you retire early
 - Full retirement age (67): You get 100% of the benefits
 - **Medicare (our focus):** At age 65, you are eligible for publicly provided health insurance through Medicare.

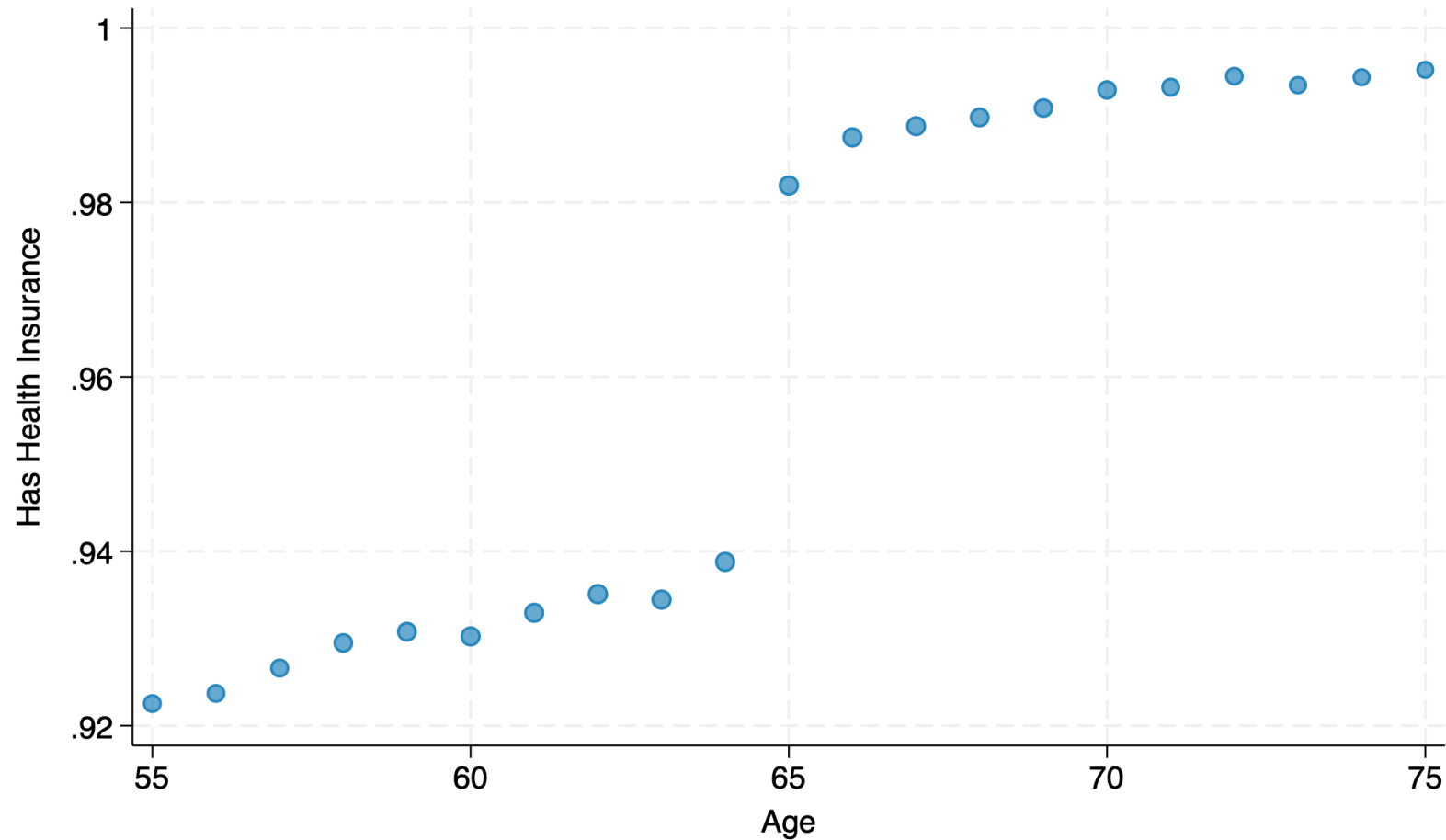
Regression Discontinuity

- All of these policies are determined by a cutoff rule
- If we had more data, we could be even more careful and measure age in days at look at changes right around the time you turn 62, 65, 67, etc.
 - Age-based discontinuities can sometimes be less compelling than things like test scores
 - Why? It could be that individuals one year age difference are actually quite different. This is why regression discontinuities at age 18 or 21 are a bit less convincing

Probability of Having Medicare



Probability of Having Any Health Insurance



Probability of Being in the Labor Force

